Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Sunday, 1 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
13° 10°	12° 6°	12° 6°	12° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Calls are growing for the British government to formally apologise for slavery, with Andy Burnham saying he's 'open' to the idea.**
The Mayor of Greater Manchester's comments come after repeated requests from Commonwealth leaders for an official apology. However, Mr Burnham has stated he doesn't support reparations.
POLITICS · UK

2 **Sir Keir Starmer has warned that Europe can no longer rely on the US to 'bankroll' its defence.**
The Labour leader said the US has made it clear that 'things will not go back to the way they were'. He suggested Europe must now take more responsibility for its own security.
POLITICS · UK

3 **The Home Secretary, Mahmood, is expected to announce changes to the rules around indefinite leave to remain in the UK.**
These potential new rules for migrant workers already in the UK have faced opposition from within the government. Details of the proposed changes are anticipated soon.
POLITICS · UK

4 **A British woman's family has been told the UK has 'no authority' over the case of her killing by her father in the US.**
Jane Coates wrote to Cheshire police urging them to gather evidence into Lucy Harrison's death. This highlights the complexities of international legal jurisdiction.
CRIME · UK

5 **A man has been found guilty of rape after a woman's phone recording provided crucial evidence.**
Police stated that the recording, where the woman is clearly heard saying 'no', was key to the conviction. This case underscores the importance of digital evidence in court.
CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Great news for aspiring artists in the North, as plans for a Brit School North arts college have been given the green light!**

Inspired by the world-famous Brit School in London, this new college will be built in the heart of Bradford. It's hoped it will nurture the next generation of UK talent.

ON AIR — What kind of talent do you think this new school will discover? Who's your favourite Brit School success story?

ARTS · FUTURE

2 **Actress Gabrielle Creevy has revealed she loved playing 'a very Welsh assassin' in the upcoming spy drama Black Doves.**

She shared that she auditioned for the role using her natural Welsh accent, and the production team 'loved it'. The series is set to be a big hit.

ON AIR — Are you looking forward to seeing Gabrielle Creevy in Black Doves? Do you think more roles should embrace regional accents?

TV · FUTURE

3 **Award-winning singer Raye has hit back at ticket touts after an 'overwhelming' sign-up for her Royal Albert Hall show.**

She revealed there were a staggering 1.8 million sign-ups for just 5,000 seats. It shows the incredible demand for her live performances.

ON AIR — Have you ever been affected by ticket touts? What do you think can be done to stop them?

MUSIC · FUTURE

4 **The illustrator of The Gruffalo, Axel Scheffler, is reportedly considering legal action against AI firms.**

He believes these companies are breaching copyright by reproducing his distinctive work in AI-generated Gruffalo images. It's a growing concern for many artists.

ON AIR — Is AI-generated art a threat to human creativity? What do you think about AI using existing artwork?

ART · FUTURE

5 **A refugee athlete is set to make history for the second time at the Youth Olympics.**

Yiech Pur Biel will lead the first ever refugee team to take part in the event. It's an inspiring story of determination and hope on the world stage.

ON AIR — Isn't this a fantastic story? What an incredible achievement for Yiech Pur Biel and his team!

OLYMPICS · FUTURE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Lisandro Martinez's 'inexplicable' 83 seconds cost Manchester United dearly in their 2-0 defeat to Chelsea at Stamford Bridge.**

The defender was condemned for a costly red card, which significantly impacted United's chances. It was a frustrating night for Michael Carrick's side.

ON AIR — Do you think Martinez's red card was deserved? How much did it change the game?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **David Warner has torn into his former side Australia, labelling their performance 'un-Australian' after South Africa charged to a Test win.**

Australia crumbled under the pressure of a final-day chase, allowing South Africa to secure a famous Test and series victory. Warner didn't hold back in his criticism.

ON AIR — Is it fair for former players to be so critical of their old teams? What do you make of Warner's comments?

CRICKET · GLOBAL

3 **Joe Cokanasiga scored twice as Bath ended a three-game winless run in all competitions with a 36-28 victory over Sale.**

It was a much-needed win for Bath, with Cokanasiga's impressive performance helping them secure the points. This result will give them a boost.

ON AIR — What a performance from Cokanasiga! Are Bath now back on track after this win?

RUGBY · UK

4 **A tearful Harriet Dart has reached her first WTA Tour singles final, saying it 'means the world' to her.**

The Briton battled past China's Sun Xinran at the Guangzhou Open to qualify for her maiden final. It's a huge moment in her career.

ON AIR — What a fantastic achievement for Harriet Dart! Will you be cheering her on in the final?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

5 **Voting figures reveal Harry Kane beat Kylian Mbappe to the men's Ballon d'Or by just 28 points, one of the tightest margins ever.**

It's the first time an English player has lifted the trophy since Michael Owen in 2001. This close result shows how highly both players are regarded.

ON AIR — Were you surprised by how close the Ballon d'Or vote was? Do you think Kane deserved the win over Mbappe?

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new online trend sees people sharing their unexpected joy of 'mastering a perfectly flipped pancake'.**
It seems the simple act of launching a pancake into the air and catching it perfectly in the pan is bringing small bursts of triumph to kitchens across the nation.

2 **The humble 'doorstop' is receiving an unexpected surge of appreciation in a recent home decor survey.**
Participants highlighted its quiet reliability and surprisingly varied designs, from classic wedges to quirky animal shapes, as key to its charm.

3 **Many are rediscovering the subtle satisfaction of 'lining up books on a shelf' by colour or size.**
This simple act of organisation is reported to bring a calming sense of order and visual appeal to living spaces.

4 **There's a growing appreciation for the unique sound of 'leaves crunching underfoot' on an autumn walk.**
It's being hailed as a simple pleasure that connects us to nature and signals the changing seasons.

5 **The unexpected pleasure of 'finding a matching pair of socks' immediately after doing the laundry is a new focus of a social media trend.**
Users are celebrating the small victory of avoiding the dreaded 'odd sock' pile, even if just for a day.

6 **A recent online poll suggests a surge in affection for the 'cosy warmth of a hot water bottle' on a chilly evening.**
It seems the classic comfort item is experiencing a nostalgic resurgence as a simple, effective way to stay warm.

7 **People are finding surprising delight in the delicate art of 'perfectly stirring sugar into their tea' without spilling a drop.**
This small, mindful moment in a daily routine is reported to bring a sense of calm and accomplishment to many.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new piece of clothing in a shop will be comfortable, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: SWIRLING THE TEACUP CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES BEFORE THE FIRST SIP!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a new 'short cut' in your daily routine that saves you just a minute or two, but feels like a huge win?**
  What's that little everyday hack you've found recently that has made your life just a tiny bit easier or more efficient?

- **We all have that 'one particular kitchen utensil' that we absolutely couldn't do without, even if it's not the fanciest gadget.**
  What's your ultimate desert island kitchen tool, and why is it so indispensable to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the world's first ever postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the United Kingdom in 1840?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first recorded use of an umbrella was in ancient Egypt, primarily to shade royalty from the sun's rays.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£82 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£82 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron in the heat.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when they are separated.
- The 'sixth' mass extinction event on Earth is currently happening, largely driven by human activities.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SUN 1 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 305 of the year, 60 days left in 2026. Today All Saints' Day, a holy day of obligation in some areas (a national holiday in many historically Catholic countries), and its related observance: Day of the Innocents, The first day of Day of the Dead or El Dia de los Muertos celebration. (Mexico, Haiti); Anniversary of the Revolution (Algeria); Chavang Kut (Mizo people of Northeast India, Bangladesh, Burma); Chhattisgarh Rajyotsava (Chhattisgarh, India). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Calvin Johnson, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1994 — James Ward-Prowse, English footballer
- 1975 — Bo Bice, American singer and musician
- 1962 — Anthony Kiedis, American singer-songwriter
- 1951 — Ronald Bell, American singer-songwriter, saxophonist, and producer (died 2020)
- 1949 — Belita Moreno, American actress and acting coach
- 1957 — Lyle Lovett, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1941 — Robert Foxworth, American actor and director

THE DAY TODAY

- 1987 — British Rail Class 43 (HST) hits the record speed of 238 km/h for rail vehicles with on-board fuel to generate electricity for traction motors.
- 1997 — Titanic premieres publicly at Tokyo festival, launching a global blockbuster career.
- 1973 — The Indian state of Mysore is renamed as Karnataka to represent all the regions within Karunadu.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2001 — Turkey, Australia, and Canada agree to commit troops to the invasion of Afghanistan.
- 1956 — The Indian states Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Mysore are formally created under the States Reorganisation Act; Kanyakumari district is joined to Tamil Nadu from Kerala. Delhi was established as a union territory.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1987 — British Rail Class 43 (HST) hits the record speed of 238 km/h for rail vehicles with on-board fuel to generate electricity for traction motors.

- 1957 — The Mackinac Bridge, the world's longest suspension bridge between anchorages at the time, opens to traffic connecting Michigan's upper and lower peninsulas.
- 1968 — The Motion Picture Association of America's film rating system is officially introduced, originating with the ratings G, M, R, and X.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES MON 2 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 306 of the year, 59 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Agapius and companions; Christian feast day: Domninus of Vienne; Christian feast day: Erc of Slane (Ireland); Christian feast day: Justus of Trieste. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1921 — Shepard Menken, American actor (died 1999)
- 1962 — Derek Mountfield, English footballer and manager
- 1975 — Chris Walla, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1974 — Nelly, American rapper
- 1944 — Keith Emerson, English pianist, keyboard player, and composer (died 2016)
- 1972 — Samantha Womack, British actress, singer and director
- 1957 — Carter Beauford, American drummer and composer
- 1964 — Alan Tait, English-Scottish rugby player and coach

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2020 — In Vienna's Innere Stadt district, an ISIL sympathizer shoots and kills four people and injures 23 more, before being shot and killed by the police.
- 1997 — Tropical Storm Linda makes landfall in the Mekong Delta in Vietnam, causing more than 3,000 deaths.
- 1959 — Quiz show scandals: Twenty-One game show contestant Charles Van Doren admits to a Congressional committee that he had been given questions and answers in advance.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — Suez Crisis: Israel occupies the Gaza Strip.
- 1964 — King Saud of Saudi Arabia is deposed by a family coup, and replaced by his half-brother Faisal.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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